Party	*2004*	*2009*	*2014*	*2019*
BJP	8.2	10.2	8.9	12.6
INC	10.8	9.8	12.9	12.8
BSP	4.6	5.6	5.4	6.3
SP	4.6	8.4	14.1	16.2
CPI	5.9	7.1	9.0	8.2
CPI (M)	11.6	7.3	11.8	14.5
JD (U)	2.1	5.8	5.4	8.3
Shiv Sena	3.6	4.5	5.0	52.2
NCP	18.2	10.3	11.1	2.9
Trinamool Congress	18.18	18.5	28.8	37.09
BJD	8.3	0	9.52	33.3
AIADMK	6.06	8.6	10.0	6.6
DMK	12.5	9.09	5.7	8.6
TDP	12.1	3.2	3.3	12.0
YSR-CP	-	-	13.1	11.7
TRS	-	11.1	5.8	11.7
AAP	-	-	13.4	15

Source: ECI data on women participation in Lok Sabha polls analysed by Nalin Mehta, Rishabh Srivastava. This has been cross-referenced with year-wise datasets on women's representation made available by the Association of Democratic Reforms (ADR). Where there were discrepancies between ECI's original source data/its subsequent analytical tables and the ADR's data analysis, we have gone by ECI numbers.[74]

Of course, merely giving tickets to women is not necessarily a marker of greater women's participation. The Samajwadi Party in 2019 gave more tickets to women as a proportion of its total candidates (16.2 per cent) than either the BJP or the Congress. Many of these women were wives or relatives of political leaders and nobody thinks of the SP as a paragon of women's empowerment. Yet, representation does matter, especially in political formations that